FIRST CUSTOMER

First Customer — 10 Days to Your First Paying Customers — Day 9: The Close: From Yes to Payment

Study guide · Self-study

10 Days to Your First Paying Customers · Day 9: The Close: From Yes to Payment

How to Use This Guide

This is your Day 9 guide. You work through it alone, at your own pace, in your own business. Write your answers down as you go; thinking about them is not the same as writing them. Keep your notes from Days 1–8 nearby, because today you turn everything you have learned into money in your account. Read one section, then do the short exercise that follows it. When you reach What Would You Say?, write your own answer before you look at the Model Answers at the back. The model answers are examples, not scripts. Your words should sound like you.

> **NOTES**
>
> The most common mistake on closing day is to treat the close as a separate event. It is the natural end of a conversation you already started.

Today's Objectives (KASU)

By the end of this unit you will be able to move a customer from a verbal yes to a completed payment without pressure, and without losing the trust you built in Days 3 to 8.

- Knowledge: You will know the Commitment Close, MEDJAY's adaptation based on Voss, Kahneman, Dixon and Adamson, and Cialdini, and its five steps: Criteria, Evidence, Consequence, Calibrated question, Genuine choice.
- Attitude: You will treat the close as a service to the customer, not a test of your persuasion. A clear next step respects their time more than a vague maybe.
- Skill: You will be able to restate a customer's own criteria, present the evidence, ask a What or How question, and offer real choices of next step with a date.
- Upskill: You will design a friction-free payment path for your own business, B2B or B2C, and use it with three real customers before Day 10.

Why a Yes Is Not a Payment

A customer saying yes feels wonderful. It is also the most dangerous moment in your first sales cycle. Cialdini’s work on commitment and consistency shows that people are far more likely to follow through on an action they have stated clearly, in their own words, with a date attached. A warm nod and a “sounds great” costs the customer nothing and can evaporate in a week. Your job today is to convert warm feeling into a concrete step.

The psychology is simple. Customers delay not because they do not want your product, but because deciding is effort. Every extra step you ask of them is a small cost that competes with doing nothing. When the path to payment is short and obvious, the effort of deciding falls and the yes survives.

Practice example: A B2B founder sells a bookkeeping service to a small design studio. The owner says, “This is exactly what we need.” Two weeks later, nothing is signed. The founder had sent a long proposal and asked the owner to “review and get back.” The owner was busy, the email sank and

the yes faded. A one-page agreement and a payment link in the same conversation would have closed it that day.

> **NOTES**
>
> Watch for the customer who agrees enthusiastically but never asks a practical question about payment. Enthusiasm without logistics is often a polite exit.

The Commitment Close

The Commitment Close (MEDJAY adaptation, based on Voss, Kahneman, Dixon and Adamson, and Cialdini) is MEDJAY's close. It is the logical conclusion of the process, not pressure, and the customer can still say no. It replaces the assumptive close. The five steps are used in order, and each one builds on the last.

Step 1, Criteria: restate the customer's own criteria, in their words. This reminds them what they decided to optimize for and shows you listened.

Step 2, Evidence: show the evidence against those criteria. Only verified facts: what the product does, what the pilot showed, what the price includes.

Step 3, Consequence: name the consequences honestly, including when waiting is better. If their situation genuinely allows a wait, say so. That honesty is what makes the close credible.

Step 4, Calibrated question: ask a What or How question, never a yes/no question. A yes/no question invites a reflex 'yes' that costs the customer nothing. A What or How question asks them to think, and their answer tells you where they really are.

Step 5, Genuine choice: offer real choices of next step, with a date. Not a fake choice between two options you invented; real choices, such as starting now or starting after their busy period.

Why it works: the customer hears their own priorities reflected back, sees checkable facts, and keeps control. People commit most readily when the decision feels like their own and the next step is small and clear.

> **NOTES**
>
> Notice the order. If you offer the choice before you restate the criteria, the customer has nothing to measure the choice against.

Silence and the Direct Question

After you state the price or ask the commitment question, stop talking. This is uncomfortable, and that is the point. Silence hands the next move to the customer, and most founders fill it with discounts, extra features or apologies. The customer reads that filling as nervousness and starts to wonder whether the offer is really worth it.

Why silence works: people need a few seconds to process a decision. When you speak first, you interrupt their thinking and often answer your own question for them. When you stay quiet, you give them room to say what they actually think.

Then ask a direct question that invites a real decision, not a reflex. A What or How question, or a genuine choice with a date, works better than a yes/no question: “How would you like to handle the start date, so we’re up and running before the fifteenth?” is stronger than “Shall we start on the fifteenth?” The first asks the customer to think and gives you their real answer. The second invites a polite yes that costs them nothing.

Practice example: A B2C founder sells a handmade furniture piece. After showing the price, she says, “The piece is ready to ship in ten days. Would you like me to reserve it and send the payment link now, or hold it until Friday so you can check the measurements at home?” Then she waits. The customer picks one, and the sale moves.

> **NOTES**
>
> If you find yourself talking during the silence, count three slow breaths in your head before you say anything.

B2B: The Simple Agreement and Clear Payment Terms

In business-to-business selling, the close usually needs two things: a short written agreement and clear payment terms. The agreement protects both sides and removes ambiguity. Keep it to one or two pages: what you deliver, when, the price, the payment schedule and one line on how either side can end it. If the customer's legal or finance process requires specific terms, check the current requirements where you operate before you sign.

Clear payment terms matter more than clever wording. State the amount, what it covers, when it is due and how it is paid. A deposit before work starts is normal and protects your cash flow. If you ask for a deposit, say why: it reserves time and commits capacity.

Worked B2B example: A SaaS founder sells a scheduling tool to a dental clinic group. Criteria: 'You said you need to cut no-shows without hiring more front-desk staff.' Evidence: 'In the four-week pilot, no-shows dropped from fourteen to six per month across two locations.' Consequence: 'If we wait another quarter, you carry that gap through your busiest period.' Calibrated question: 'How would you like to handle the rollout so it is running before your next busy month?' Genuine choice: 'We can start on the first with both locations, or start with one location on the first and add the second after four weeks. Which fits better?' Then a one-page agreement and a deposit invoice, sent in the same conversation.

> **NOTES**
>
> Send the agreement while you are still with the customer, on the call or in the meeting. A document sent later competes with everything else in their inbox.

B2C: Streamline Checkout and Remove Friction

In business-to-consumer selling, the close happens at checkout. Every unnecessary field, every extra click, every unanswered question is a place where the customer leaves. Look at your own buying path and count the steps from 'I want this' to 'paid'. Then remove at least one.

Common friction points: a form that asks for information you will never use, a payment method that is not obvious, a delivery time that is not stated, a return policy that is hard to find. Each one creates a small moment of doubt, and doubt is where the sale dies.

Say the next step plainly. 'Tap the link, choose your size, and you will get a confirmation within a minute' is clearer than 'complete your purchase at your convenience'.

Worked B2C example: A founder sells an online course. Customers reach the payment page and stop. She removes two form fields, adds one line under the button that says when access begins, and states the refund window on the same page. Checkout completion improves. Fictional numbers: fifty people reach the page; before the changes, eighteen pay; after, twenty-nine pay. The course and the price did not change.

> **NOTES**
>
> Ask three recent customers what almost stopped them from paying. Their answers are your friction list.

Turning the Close into a Natural Next Step

The close should feel like the obvious end of a good conversation, not a sudden turn. This is why you use the earlier work: the criteria come from your discovery, the evidence comes from Day 7, and the objections you cleared came from Day 8. When the customer hears their own words come back to them, the close feels like a summary rather than a pitch.

A useful habit is to preview the close early. In the first conversation, say what the next step will look like if the offer fits. 'If this looks right, the next step is a one-page agreement and a deposit, and we can start within a week.' The customer is then not surprised when you ask. Surprise creates resistance; preview removes it.

> **NOTES**
>
> If you feel a jolt of nerves before asking, that is a sign you have not yet stated the criteria clearly. Repeat step one and try again.

Reflection

Write your answers to these questions. Be specific; specifics are what you will use tomorrow.

- Think of a customer who said yes but never paid. What was the exact moment the yes was given, and what concrete step did you ask for?
- What is the single biggest friction point in your own payment path right now?

- When a customer asks the price, what do you usually say next, and what do you usually do in the silence that follows?
- Which step of the Commitment Close do you expect to find hardest, and why?

Apply It in Your Role

As a founder, you are both the seller and the person who gets paid. This makes the close easier in one way and harder in another. Easier because you can decide terms on the spot. Harder because it is your own money, and that pressure can leak into your voice.

Build your own close kit this week. For B2B: a one-page agreement template, a deposit invoice and a short list of your standard payment terms. For B2C: a checkout page reviewed for friction, a clear statement of delivery time, and a refund line that is easy to find. Write the direct commitment question you will use, in your own words, and say it out loud until it sounds like you.

- Write your one-sentence direct commitment question: _____
- List the three steps a customer takes from yes to paid in your business: _____
- Name the one step you will remove or simplify this week: _____
- Write the date you will use the Commitment Close with your next customer: _____

What Would You Say?

Write your own answer to each situation before you look at the Model Answers. Keep your answers short and in your own words.

- A B2B customer says, 'This is great, let me think about it.' You have already restated their criteria and shown the evidence. What do you say next, and what do you do after you say it?
- A B2C customer has your product in the basket and stops at the payment page. You are chatting with them online. What single question do you ask?
- A customer asks for a lower price at the moment of payment. What do you say that does not give the discount away for free?

> **NOTES**
>
> Attempt every answer in writing before reading the model answers. The writing is where the learning happens.

Key Takeaways

Summarize today in five short lines you can reread before your next customer conversation.

Today you learned to carry a customer from yes to payment. You met the Commitment Close and its five steps, practiced silence after the offer, and looked at the practical path to payment for B2B and B2C selling. You saw that the close is not a separate performance but the summary of everything the

customer already told you. Tomorrow, in Day 10, you will build the follow-up and pipeline habits that keep paying customers coming.

- A yes is not a payment. The close is a concrete step with a date.
- The Commitment Close (MEDJAY adaptation, based on Voss, Kahneman, Dixon and Adamson, and Cialdini) runs Criteria, Evidence, Consequence, Calibrated question, Genuine choice.
- Ask a What or How question, never a yes/no question, then stay silent.
- In B2B, keep the agreement simple and the payment terms clear. In B2C, remove friction from checkout.
- The close should feel like the natural end of the conversation, so preview it early.

Quiz

Choose one answer per question. Write it down before you look at the answer key.

1. In the Commitment Close, what comes immediately before the calibrated question?

   A. The genuine choice
   B. The consequence
   C. The deposit invoice
   D. The evidence

2. Which question is a calibrated question?

   A. Do you want to move forward?
   B. Can you sign today?
   C. How would you like to handle the rollout?
   D. Is the price acceptable?

3. A B2B customer says yes but does not pay for two weeks. What is the most likely cause?

   A. They changed their mind completely
   B. The path from yes to payment had too much friction
   C. The price was too low
   D. You did not present enough features

4. What is the purpose of silence after you state the price?

   A. To make the customer uncomfortable
   B. To give the customer time to process and answer in their own words
   C. To signal that you will lower the price
   D. To create urgency

5. A customer asks for a lower price at payment. What is the correct response in this course?

   A. Give the discount to keep the yes
   B. Refuse and end the conversation
   C. Ask for something of equal value in return

D. Offer a fake deadline to force the decision

Upskill Challenge

Before Day 10, complete this challenge in your own business. Write down what happened, in your own words.

☐ Build your close kit: a one-page agreement or a checkout review, plus your written payment terms.

☐ Write your direct commitment question and say it out loud five times.

☐ Use the Commitment Close with three real customers or prospects.

☐ For each one, write the customer's criteria, the evidence you showed, their answer to your What or How question, and the next step with its date.

☐ Note which step of the Commitment Close felt weakest, and what you will change next time.

> **NOTES**
>
> Do this with real customers, not imagined ones. The discomfort is the training.

Model Answers

These are examples, not scripts. What matters is the principle behind each answer. Your words should sound like you.

- Situation 1: 'You mentioned the pilot cut no-shows from fourteen to six, and that your busiest month is coming. If we wait, you carry that gap through it. How would you like to handle the rollout so it is running before then?' Then stop talking and let the customer answer. Why it works: it restates the criteria, names the consequence honestly and asks a How question, so the customer does the deciding.
- Situation 2: 'I see you're at the payment step. What would make this easy to finish right now?' Why it works: one open question finds the real friction without guessing, and it respects the customer's choice.
- Situation 3: 'I can look at the price. If I hold it for a longer commitment or a faster start, would that work for you?' Why it works: this is trade, don't concede. You ask for something of equal value instead of giving money away.
- Quiz answers:
- 1. B. The consequence comes before the calibrated question; the genuine choice comes after it.
- 2. C. A What or How question asks the customer to think; the others are yes/no questions that invite a reflex.
- 3. B. A warm yes fades when the agreement or payment step is slow and unclear.
- 4. B. Silence lets the customer process and gives you their real answer.

- 5. C. Trade, don't concede: ask for something of equal value, such as a faster decision or a longer commitment.

> **NOTES**
>
> Compare your answer to the principle, not the wording. If your principle matches, your wording is fine.

References

- Cialdini, R. B. (2021). Influence, New and Expanded: The Psychology of Persuasion. Harper Business.
- Dixon, M., & Adamson, B. (2011). The Challenger Sale. Portfolio.
- Kahneman, D. (2011). Thinking, Fast and Slow. Farrar, Straus and Giroux.
- Voss, C. (2016). Never Split the Difference. Harper Business.